

Logistics Market Intelligence Report Air

Monthly Report | Aug 2026



SAMSUNG SDS

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1. Executive Summary

Demand

- June demand rose 9.6% YoY (+2.3% MoM), a clear growth trend, driven by high-value tech cargo such as semiconductors and AI servers
- July demand softened for four straight weeks after early-month strength, as e-commerce contraction from the EU's new low-value cargo tariff weighed on growth
- AI and semiconductor volumes from Taiwan, Korea, and Vietnam to North America continued double-digit growth, contrasting with the Europe-bound e-commerce slowdown and widening lane-specific differentiation

Supply

- June supply rose 4.9% YoY but trailed demand growth, keeping the market on a tight supply-demand footing
- July supply rose 1.8% YoY, a modest recovery ahead of peak season. Asia-origin transpacific freighter capacity expanded sharply, reflecting a clear shift toward high-yield lane redeployment
- Freight capacity growth (+6.3% YoY) led the increase, while passenger belly capacity declined on reduced widebody operations by Middle Eastern carriers

Freight Rates

- The Week 31 Baltic Air Freight Index stood at 2,393, down 0.6% WoW; after four straight weeks of decline since late June, the rate slide eased into a flat trend
- July's average rate was 2,460, down 8.6% MoM but still 20.4% above the year-ago level, maintaining an elevated rate environment

North America-bound rates saw limited declines on semiconductor demand, while Europe-bound rates kept falling on weaker e-commerce demand, highlighting lane differentiation

- August–September rates are likely to see a possible rebound on Asia-to-North America lanes alongside continued weakness on Europe-bound lanes, with volatility likely to resurface as Middle East airspace restrictions are extended



2. Air Market Trends

Demand Trends

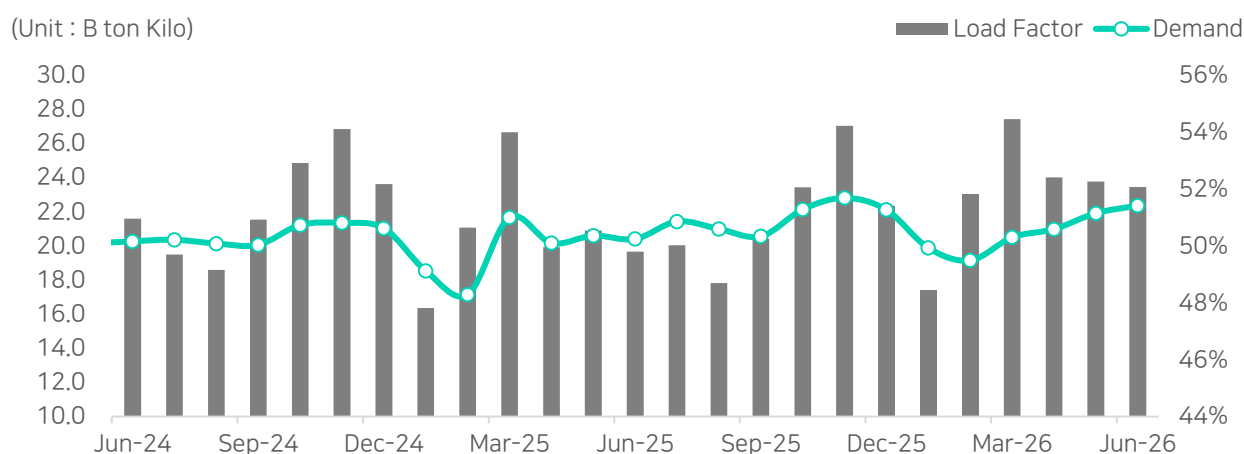
○ June 2026 Demand Trends

- June demand rose 9.6% YoY (+2.3% MoM), a clear growth trend. On Asia-to-North America lanes, resilient demand for high-value tech cargo such as semiconductors and AI servers into North America drove overall growth, while intra-Asia high-tech cargo movement also supported demand

○ July 2026 Demand Trends¹

- July demand entered a slow season after early-month high-tech strength, with weekly volumes softening for four straight weeks and growth momentum temporarily weakening
- The EU's low-value cargo tariff weighed on e-commerce demand, sharply reducing China- and Hong Kong-origin freighter capacity to Europe
- In contrast, AI and semiconductor volumes from Taiwan, Korea, and Vietnam continued double-digit growth, led by North America-bound lanes
- At Southeast Asia's intra-regional transshipment hubs, high-tech cargo is quickly replacing e-commerce volume, reshaping lane-level cargo flows
- July Demand Trends by Key Region
 - North America: down 1.0% vs prev. 2W as of Weeks 28-29, up 2.0% YoY
 - Asia: down 4.0% vs prev. 2W, up 4.0% YoY. Europe-bound volume fell a sharper 9% vs prev. 2W, driven by e-commerce weakness since the EU's low-value cargo tariff took effect
 - MEIA: down 2.0% vs prev. 2W, up 2.0% YoY. Gulf airspace restrictions diverted transshipment volume onto rerouted Central Asia corridors, while South Asia-origin demand saw a temporary adjustment from freighter suspensions tied to Mumbai airport infrastructure repairs

[Global Demand and Load Factor]²



Month	Apr	May	Jun	MoM	YoY
Load Factor	52.4%	52.3%	52.1%	-0.2%p	+2.2%p
Demand (B ton-kilo)	21.0	21.9	22.4	+2.3%	+9.6%

¹ WorldACD

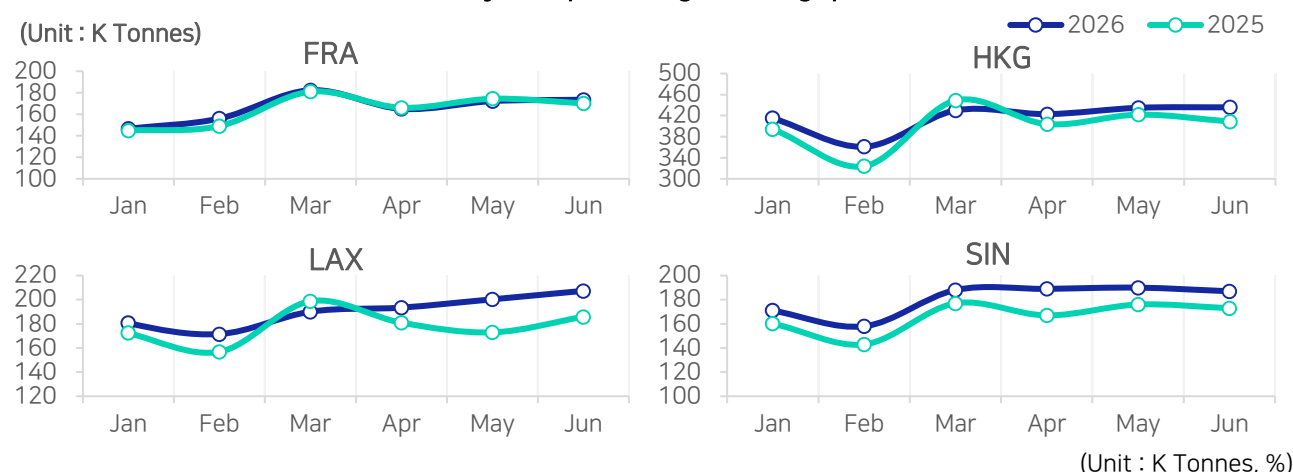
² IATA, Monthly statistics



Major Airport Cargo Throughput

- Frankfurt Airport (FRA)
 - June 2026 cargo throughput was 173.5K tonnes, up 2.0% YoY, a modest recovery
 - EU-Asia demand held steady; M.E rerouting costs continue to constrain long-haul capacity recovery
 - Hub carrier Lufthansa launched its automated hub construction project in June, targeting conversion into Europe's top cargo hub by 2030
- Hong Kong International Airport (HKG)
 - June 2026 cargo throughput was 436.0K tonnes, up 6.6% YoY
 - Transshipment volume led the growth, with first-half throughput up YoY overall on a solid trend. Europe-bound volume within this contracted on the low-value cargo tariff, but new freighter routes are expected to keep expanding the network
- Los Angeles International Airport (LAX)
 - June 2026 cargo throughput was 207.3K tonnes, up 11.6% YoY, double-digit growth
 - Transpacific inflows of semiconductor and electronics cargo from Asia drove the strong volume, with urgent-demand shipments supporting growth
- Singapore Changi Airport (SIN)
 - June 2026 cargo throughput was 187.0K tonnes, up 8.1% YoY, a solid growth streak for a fourth straight month
 - High-tech growth centered on China, U.S., Australia, Hong Kong, and India as top markets, lifting transshipment
 - Southeast Asia's role as an intra-regional transshipment hub is strengthening, deepening a high-value cargo-centered throughput structure and reinforcing regional connectivity

[Major Airport Cargo Throughput]³



Month	Frankfurt Airport		Hong Kong Intl. Airport		Los Angeles Intl. Airport		Singapore Changi Airport	
	Volume	YoY(%)	Volume	YoY(%)	Volume	YoY(%)	Volume	YoY(%)
Apr-26	165.0	-0.6%	423.0	4.7%	193.5	6.9%	189.0	13.2%
May-26	172.3	-1.2%	435.0	3.1%	200.3	15.8%	190.0	8.0%
Jun-26	173.5	2.0%	436.0	6.6%	207.3	11.6%	187.0	8.1%

³ CAPA, Data Centre



Supply Trends

○ June 2026 Supply Trends⁴

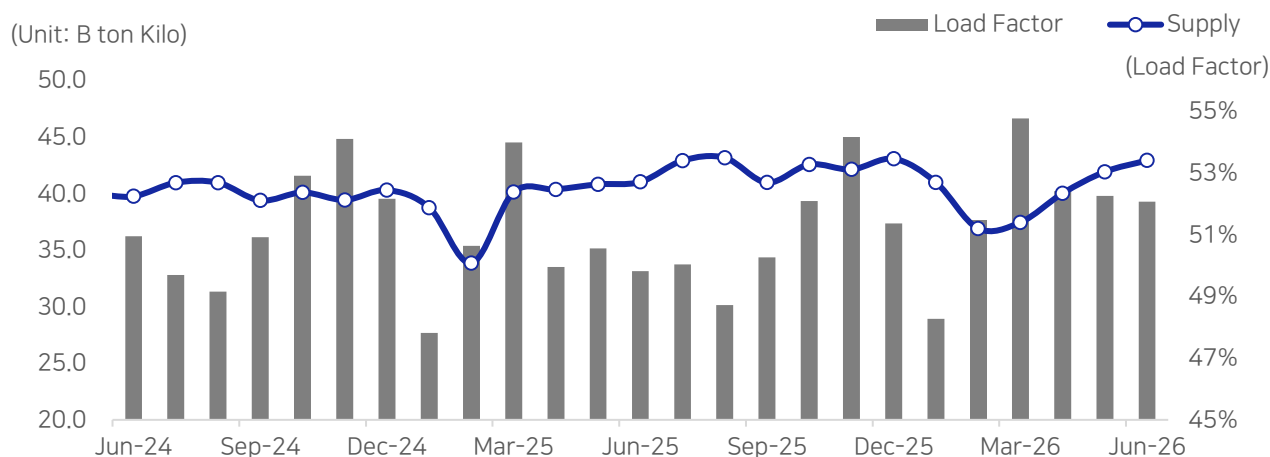
- June supply rose 4.9% YoY (+2.4% MoM), continuing a modest expansion
- Belly capacity recovery and added Asia-N.A frequencies drove supply growth, with freighters also rising; growth still trailed demand, keeping supply-demand tight and load factor edging higher
**Demand growth 9.6%* **YoY*

○ July 2026 Supply Trends⁵

- July supply rose 1.8% YoY (+2.2% vs prior 4 weeks), a gradual recovery ahead of peak season
- Supply share: passenger aircraft 41%, freighters 41%, express carriers 18%, freighter growth led the increase
 - By aircraft type, YoY supply changed: passenger aircraft -2.8%, freighters +6.3%, express carriers +2.9%
 - Passenger capacity rose 3.2% MoM but fell 2.8% YoY, reflecting reduced widebody operations by M.E carriers
- July Supply Trends by Key Region (Week 29)⁶
 - Supply recovered across all regions YoY: Asia +2%, N.A +3%, Europe flat, and MEIA +4%
 - Asia-origin supply showed a clear shift toward high-yield lane redeployment, with Northeast Asia-centered transpacific freighter capacity surging 16% YoY; summer peak-season passenger capacity is also expected to expand mainly on transpacific lanes **May*
 - MEIA-origin supply saw freighter routes redeployed to hubs like Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan amid Gulf airspace restrictions, driving double-digit-plus growth there, while Gulf-origin supply stayed below pre-conflict levels **Navoi* **Almaty*
 - South Asia-origin supply is expected to remain affected by freighter suspensions from Mumbai airport apron repairs, until operations are shifted to nearby airports **Navi Mumbai - Dec*

**2026.8-2027.5 Apron Repaving*

[Global Supply and Load Factor]⁷



Month	Apr	May	Jun	MoM	YoY
Load Factor	52.4%	52.3%	52.1%	-0.2%p	+2.2%p
Supply (B ton-kilo)	40.0	41.9	42.9	+2.4%	+4.9%

⁴ IATA, Air Cargo Market Analysis

⁵ Seabury

⁶ WorldACD

⁷ IATA, Monthly statistics



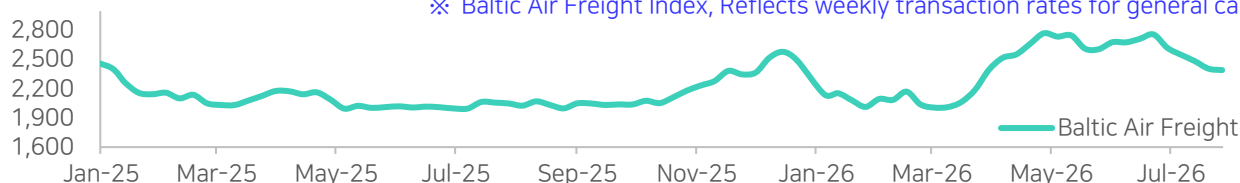
3. Air Market Outlook & Freight Index Trends

Air Freight Composite Index and Route Trend Analysis

- W31 Baltic Air Freight Index was 2,393, -0.6% WoW, moving flat after four weeks of decline since late June
- July's average rate was 2,460, -8.6% MoM but still 20.4% above the year-ago level, keeping rates elevated
- Asia-EU customs-cleared volume contracted after the EU's low-value cargo tariff, weighing on July rates
- M.E airspace risk added jet fuel cost pressure, partly limiting the decline, with signs of a rebound in early August

[Air Freight Composite Index]⁸

※ Baltic Air Freight Index, Reflects weekly transaction rates for general cargo



※ MoM, YoY : based on monthly averages

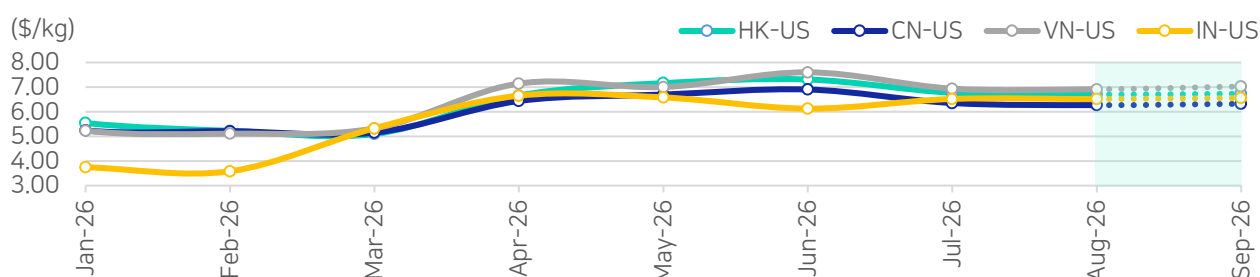
Week	W28	W29	W30	W31	WoW(%)	Jul. Avg	MoM(%)	YoY(%)
BAI00	2,551	2,486	2,408	2,393	-0.6%	2,460	-8.6%	20.4%

- July Air Cargo Market Trends by Key Region
 - China- and Hong Kong-origin rates to Europe fell 8.5–16.4% MoM on the low-value cargo tariff
 - Korea- and Taiwan-origin rates fell only ~1% MoM on semiconductor and AI server demand, up 34.7–61.4% YoY, far outpacing the composite index and keeping rate pressure firm
 - S.E Asia-to-N.A rates fell 8.7% MoM but remained a firm 27.6% above the year-ago level
 - India-to-N.A rates rose 6.4% MoM and 8.4% WoW, the strongest upward momentum among Asia-N.A lanes

Samsung SDS Short Term Forecast

- August's market should see July's decline settle, with a rebound on Asia-to-N.A lanes and EU-bound softness
 - N.A-bound lanes: structural demand for semiconductors and AI servers cargo should persist, with rates likely to stabilize or edge higher on TW- and KR-origin lanes; a renewed jet fuel rise could add upside
 - EU-bound lanes: e-commerce weakness may persist through August, keeping rates soft ahead of peak season
 - M.E-origin and transit lanes: extended airspace restrictions through August may bring renewed volatility, with rerouting a key swing factor for rates

[Samsung SDS TAC Forecast]⁹



⁸ TAC index

⁹ Samsung SDS Brightics

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U.S. Tariff Policy: A Quick Overview

Registration date | JUN 02, 2026

Tariff Summary by Country

Category	date	Details of Tariff Policies
		USTR Announces Plan to Impose Additional Tariffs Under Section 301 on 60 Economies Over Forced Labor Concerns - USTR determined that insufficient import restrictions and enforcement against goods produced with forced labor in certain economies have contributed to circumvention and unfair competition for U.S. companies, and is moving to impose tariffs under Section 301 of the Trade Act - Additional tariffs will be applied at different rates by dividing the economies into two groups

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